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Vice & Virtue Guide

Name the feeling · Find the virtue · Take one step

Every difficult feeling is pointing at something. Not a flaw to hate -- a place where a specific grace wants to grow. The Church has always taught that each vice has a corresponding virtue that heals it, the way a specific medicine meets a specific ailment. This is not about trying harder. It is about turning toward the exact grace God is offering you in this exact moment. Find what you are feeling below, and let it show you where God wants to meet you.

+ *"Put on then, as God's chosen ones, compassion, kindness, humility, meekness, and patience." -- Colossians 3:12*

HOW TO USE THIS GUIDE

When a hard feeling rises, do not push it away and do not drown in it. Do three things. Name it -- find the closest feeling on the pages that follow. Receive the virtue -- notice the grace God is offering as the remedy. Take one step -- do the single small practice listed. You are not fixing yourself. You are turning toward God one small turn at a time.

Remember: the feeling itself is not a sin (CCC 1767). It is information. What you do with it is where you grow. Turn before you feel like turning -- the feeling follows the act.

FIND WHAT YOU ARE FEELING

WHEN I FEEL **Fear & Worry** **WORK ON** ***Abandonment / Trust***

The pull: The mind runs to the worst case. The Controller says plan harder; the future feels safer to live in than the present.

+ "Do not be anxious about tomorrow." -- Matthew 6:34

Practice: Name one thing you are trying to control. Open your hands and pray: 'Lord, I give You this.'

WHEN I FEEL **Anger & Irritation** **WORK ON** ***Meekness / Gentleness***

The pull: The bodyguard standing in front of a softer feeling -- usually hurt, fear, or exhaustion underneath.

+ "A gentle answer turns away wrath." -- Proverbs 15:1

Practice: Before you respond, name what the anger is protecting. Speak to that instead.

WHEN I FEEL **Comparison & Envy** **WORK ON** ***Gratitude / Magnanimity***

The pull: Measuring your insides against someone else's outside. The ache to be seen and valued, turned sideways.

+ "Rejoice with those who rejoice." -- Romans 12:15

Practice: Name three specific gifts God has given you today. Bless the person you envied, by name.

WHEN I FEEL **Shame & Self-Contempt**

The pull: The inner critic mistaken for the voice of God. It sounds like humility but it is pride turned inward.

+ "There is now no condemnation for those in Christ." -- Romans 8:1

Practice: Say the true thing God says about you out loud, even if you cannot feel it yet.

FIND WHAT YOU ARE FEELING · CONTINUED

WHEN I FEEL **Overwhelm & Exhaustion** WORK ON ***Trust / Holy Rest***

The pull: Carrying what was never yours to carry. Doing for others what only God can do.

+ "Come to me, all who labor. I will give you rest." -- Matthew 11:28

Practice: Choose one thing to lay down today. Ask one person for help with it.

WHEN I FEEL **Bitterness & Resentment** WORK ON ***Mercy / Forgiveness***

The pull: A wound rehearsed until it hardens. Holding an offense as if letting go means it did not matter.

+ "Forgive, as the Lord has forgiven you." -- Colossians 3:13

Practice: Name the offense honestly to God. Ask for the desire to forgive, even before you can forgive.

WHEN I FEEL **Vanity & People-Pleasing**

The pull: Performing for approval. The Pleaser says yes when the heart means no, to stay loved and safe.

+ "Am I trying to please people, or God?" -- Galatians 1:10

Practice: Do one small thing today for God's eyes alone -- no one else will know.

WHEN I FEEL **Discouragement & Sloth** WORK ON ***Fortitude / Zeal***

The pull: The quiet giving-up. The feeling that showing up does not matter, so why begin.

+ "Let us not grow weary in doing good." -- Galatians 6:9

Practice: Do the next small faithful thing anyway, before the feeling changes. The feeling follows the act.

WHEN I FEEL **Control & Distrust** WORK ON ***Abandonment / Faith***

The pull: White-knuckling an outcome only God can hold. Mistaking control for responsibility.

+ "Cast all your anxiety on him, for he cares for you." -- 1 Peter 5:7

Practice: Name what is genuinely yours to do. Do that. Hand the outcome back to God, out loud.

WORK IT THROUGH

What am I feeling most often right now? Name it as precisely as you can.

What is that feeling pointing at -- what does it want me to control, protect, or prove?

What virtue is God offering me as the remedy? What would it look like in my actual day?

What is the one small practice I will do this week -- decided now, in the calm?

A WORD ON THE PREDOMINANT FAULT

One of these feelings likely shows up more than all the others. That is a clue to your predominant fault -- the one root that feeds most of your struggles. You do not have to fight all of these at once. Find the one virtue that heals your deepest pattern, and give God that one. Depth, not breadth. One faithful turn, repeated, becomes a life.

+ *"He who began a good work in you will bring it to completion." -- Philippians 1:6*